

## Phone delays and shortages

Thanks to COVID-19, we'll probably see delay and shortages in phone launches worldwide. <https://digit.in/mar20-71>



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# 1MORE Dual Driver BT ANC

## Immersiveness merged with awareness

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MORE is popular for not only sound quality but also their close attention to design.

With the 1MORE Dual Driver BT ANC earphones, they have traversed into the landscape of ANC-enabled headphones. The company has surprisingly chosen to go with an open-back design for these ANC earphones. Let's see how this unlikely coupling fared in our review.

### Build and design

1MORE continues to deliver clean and aesthetic packaging with the 1MORE Dual Driver BT ANC headphones. In the box, you find the neckband-style earphones itself, an airplane adaptor, 3 extra sizes of silicone tips, 4 sizes of silicone wings, a carrying pouch, a passive 3.5mm audio cable, a USB Type-C charger and the usual paperwork.

The wide array of silicone tips and wings ensure that users are able to find the perfect fit. The neckband is primarily made out of rubber while the modules have a metallic sheen. The left module is where you will discover all the controls and ports. Next to the power button, you have an ANC switch. You can choose between ANC level 1 and 2. Level 1 mutes some of the background sounds while Level 2 is the maximum level of ANC. Flicking this button to the left turns on Hearthrough mode that enhances environmental sounds. There's the pause/play button, which also lets you answer or decline phone calls and seek tracks and volume controller.

The earbuds have a metallic finish and feature a 45-degree angled nozzle design for a secure fit. Overall, the earphones feel comfortable and secure inside the ear. The earbuds also feature powerful magnets which attach to each other when lying on your chest.

### Features

The headline feature on the 1MORE Dual Driver BT ANC earphones is the Active Noise Cancelling feature. It is



a seemingly odd feature since the earphones are actually open-back which means that the isolation is close to zero. Still, the ANC is quite decent. It successfully eliminates most low, constant rumbles. However, the ANC on these falls prey to one of the most common pitfalls with ANC-enabled headphones. There's a constant hiss present in the background which is quite audible. Hearthrough mode, on the other hand, is exceptional on these.

The 1MORE Dual Driver BT ANC can also be used passively. They feature a battery life of about 6.5 hours as per our tests with ANC on. However, to our disappointment, these earphones need to be turned ON, even to be used passively. This completely negates the usability of a wired cable, in our opinion.

Sadly, these earphones come with Bluetooth v4.2 instead of 5.0. They do come with USB Type-C charging though. They also have an app but it does not have a customisable EQ. Also, the earphones support only SBC and AAC codecs, while aptX is missing.

### Performance

The earphones sport a warm-sound profile with extended lows and lower-mids. The bass response is slightly boosted, a little north neutrality but surprisingly,

the sub-bass is muted. You can hear this in *Mindstreet* by *Motherjane* where the bass guitar lacks punch due to the muted nature of the lower bass. Nevertheless, the bass is pretty controlled and it barely ever veils the mids.

The mids are relatively detailed on these. Vocals shine on these earphones. You can hear short breaths, sighs and more. However, there are some odd disorienting peaks introduced in the upper-mids which introduce some tinny-ness in the sound profile. Treble, on the other hand, is where the 1MORE Dual Driver BT ANC earphones fall flat (no pun intended) on their face. It is barely present and under-extended which makes it lack drive and intricate detail.

The cymbals in *Popular Monster* by *Falling in Reverse* sound lacklustre and dreary.

The soundstage is mind-numbingly wide due to the open-back design. However, imaging and instrument separation is slightly disappointing. The microphone on these earphones is quite competent. During calls, the receiver could easily understand what we were saying and the earphones did a good job mitigating sounds such as wind.

### Bottomline

Overall, the 1MORE Dual Driver BT ANC earphones are a fine pair of ANC earphones which merge immersiveness with awareness. The battery life is decent, coming in at 6.5 hours. The sound quality is mostly balanced, except for the weak treble performance. Additionally, they're comfortable to wear even over extended periods of usage. If you want to experience the immersiveness ANC provides, the 1MORE Dual Driver BT ANC earphones would be a good purchase.

—Dhriti Datta

### SPECIFICATIONS

BLUETOOTH VERSION: 4.2 | WEIGHT: 43.9g | WIRELESS RANGE: 10m/33 feet | IMPEDANCE: 32 Ω | MUSIC PLAYTIME: 7 hours | TALK TIME: 7 hours | CHARGING TIME: 1 hour | ANC: Yes | FAST CHARGE: 10 minutes for 3 hours | DRIVER TYPE: One dynamic driver and one balanced armature

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